

GENDER



BENDERS

Anoop Janardhanan vs Yamini

Make JPEG files always open with Internet Explorer



"That's easy", said Anoop when we challenged him with the task. It barely took him 20 seconds to change the file type. When asked if he knew the conventional method to do it, he took up the challenge and clicked Tools > Folder Options, and fumbled about a little before choosing File Types. There, he chose "JPEG file", clicked "Change", chose "Internet Explorer" and closed the window. We definitely have our winner—he did more than what we'd asked him to do!



Sheer excitement lit up Yamini's face when we mentioned the task. Once at the comp, she immediately opened the image and right-clicked unsuccessfully, losing a precious minute and a half in the process. After several futile attempts and a little nudging from us, she right-clicked on the file and chose Open with > Choose program > Internet Explorer. She forgot to check the "Always use..." box, and had to return to the menu for that!

The numbers say it all: thus far, Microsoft has released 54 patches for Windows XP *after* the release of SP2. So if you format your computer, that's at least 54 patches you will have to download. Also, SP2 came 51 patches after the release of SP1, and SP1 contained 33 patches. If all you have is an original vanilla Windows XP install disc,

you have a whopping 138 OS patches to install!

The news has put to bed speculation about whether SP3 would come before or after Vista was launched. For now, perhaps everyone will have to make do with third-party update patches such as AutoPatcher XP, which are not really official or recommended by Microsoft. However, it

beats connecting to Windows Update and downloading patches for hours on end, only to have to repeat the procedure if you format again!

A FIRST FOR SEAGATE

Seagate Launches Next-Gen Hard Disk

In mid-January, hard disk vendor Seagate Technology started shipping the industry's first 2.5-inch notebook PC hard drive built with perpendicular recording. The Momentus drive has a capacity of 160 GB.

Applications for the new technology extend beyond laptop and desktop machines to digital music players, mobile phones, and even enterprise-class hard drives. Over time, said Michael Hall, a spokesperson for Seagate, PR would improve storage capacity by five times the current level.

This is by no means the first commercial hard drive based on PR. A relatively unknown company called Showa Denko K.K. (SDK) commercialised, for the first time in the world, Perpendicular Recording in July of 2005. SDK started commercial production of 1.89-inch media for use in mobile music players with a 40 GB capacity—double the capacity of conventional products of the same size at the time.

Perpendicular recording (refer *Towards Terabytes*, Digit, October 2005) records data on hard disks by orienting the magnetisation of the bits perpendicular to the disk surface, rather than on the plane of the surface, as in done in Longitudinal Recording (LR). LR has almost reached its limits, meaning that so much data is packed onto a disk surface using LR that further increases are not possible. PR is the only way out, and gradually, the industry will shift entirely to PR technology. Seagate has always been a leader in PR research.

US VS REST OF THE WORLD

A New Forum For Internet Governance

In November of 2005, representatives of national governments, corporations and nonprofit organisations met in Tunisia for a summit that was expected to decide the future of the management of the Internet. Countries such as China, Cuba, Mozambique and Zimbabwe charged that the US government enjoys too much influence over the way the Internet is managed. And this was after an earlier meeting in New York that ended in a squabble between the United States and The Rest Of The World.

Basically, The Rest Of The World has long sought

Buzzword
of the MONTH

Intel Viiv

Viiv is a digital entertainment platform from Intel. It's something like a Media Center PC with many more features. PCs centred on Viiv will arrive in the first quarter of 2006.

Viiv technology-based PCs will help make it easier to download, store, view, manage and share all kinds of digital entertainment and information on a choice of TV, PC, laptop and

hand-held viewing screens. For example, you can download and watch a movie on the Viiv PC in the living room, while others listen to music streamed from the same PC through a digital media adapter in another room.

Intel says Viiv will pave the way for new entertainment experiences. But some say Viiv is just an attempt to brand a media-capable PC!